

47-Point KDP Formatting Checklist

Everything Amazon checks before approving your book

BookKraft AI — bookkraftai.com

MANUSCRIPT FILE

- | | | |
|--------|---|--|
| [
] | File format is .docx, .doc, or .epub — not .pages or .odt | <i>KDP rejects unsupported formats at upload</i> |
| [
] | No tracked changes or comments left in the document | <i>Accept all changes before saving</i> |
| [
] | File size is under 650 MB | <i>Compress images if needed</i> |
| [
] | No password protection on the file | <i>KDP cannot open encrypted files</i> |
| [
] | Filename contains no special characters or spaces | <i>Use hyphens instead: my-book-title.docx</i> |

METADATA

- | | | |
|--------|--|--|
| [
] | Title in file matches title entered in KDP dashboard exactly | <i>Case-sensitive — even one word off can cause issues</i> |
| [
] | Author name is consistent with your KDP account name | <i>Avoid pen name mismatches</i> |
| [
] | Book description is under 4,000 characters | <i>KDP hard limit — excess is cut off</i> |
| [
] | 7 keywords entered — each under 50 characters | <i>Do not repeat words already in your title</i> |
| [
] | 2 BISAC categories selected | <i>Choose the most specific subcategory available</i> |
| [
] | Language is set correctly | <i>Changing language after publish requires re-review</i> |

INTERIOR FORMATTING

- | | | |
|--------|---|--|
| [
] | Margins: at least 0.5 inch on all sides | <i>0.75 inch recommended for readability</i> |
|--------|---|--|

[]	Font is standard and embedded (Times New Roman, Garamond, Georgia)	<i>Decorative fonts may not render on all Kindle devices</i>
[]	Font size between 9pt and 12pt for body text	<i>Smaller sizes are unreadable on e-ink screens</i>
[]	Line spacing is 1.15 to 1.5 — not double-spaced	<i>Double spacing looks amateurish on e-readers</i>
[]	No manual line breaks used for paragraph spacing	<i>Use paragraph spacing instead</i>
[]	No hard-coded page numbers in body text	<i>Kindle reflows content — page numbers break</i>
[]	Chapter headings use Heading 1 style consistently	<i>Required for TOC generation to work</i>
[]	First paragraph of each chapter has no indent	<i>Use 'no indent' style for openers</i>
[]	Drop caps tested on Kindle Previewer	<i>Not all devices render drop caps correctly</i>

TABLE OF CONTENTS

[]	TOC is generated from Heading styles — not typed manually	<i>Manual TOCs break when content reflows</i>
[]	Every chapter in TOC links to correct heading	<i>Test each link in Kindle Previewer</i>
[]	NCX/logical TOC included for EPUB files	<i>Required for navigation on all devices</i>
[]	TOC page is placed after copyright page, before Chapter 1	<i>Standard KDP structure</i>

IMAGES & COVER

[]	All images are RGB — not CMYK	<i>CMYK images appear washed out on Kindle</i>
[]	Image resolution is at least 300 DPI	<i>Lower resolution looks blurry on HD screens</i>
[]	Cover image is exactly 2,560 x 1,600 px (1.6:1 ratio)	<i>Off-ratio covers are rejected automatically</i>

[]	Cover file is JPG or TIFF under 50 MB	<i>PNG covers may cause upload errors</i>
[]	No barcode, price, or 'Not for resale' text on cover	<i>KDP adds its own barcode</i>
[]	Cover text is fully inside the safe zone (no text near edges)	<i>Edge content gets cut in print</i>

EPUB VALIDATION

[]	EPUB passes EPUBCheck with zero errors	<i>Use BookKraft AI EPUB Validator — free, no login</i>
[]	No broken internal links or missing anchor targets	<i>Common cause of KDP review rejection</i>
[]	All fonts are embedded or declared in manifest	<i>Missing fonts cause fallback rendering</i>
[]	OPF spine order matches reading order	<i>Wrong order confuses e-reader navigation</i>
[]	No external CSS or JavaScript dependencies	<i>KDP strips external resources</i>

FINAL REVIEW

[]	Previewed on Kindle Previewer 3 (desktop app)	<i>Simulates Fire, Paperwhite, and phone</i>
[]	Checked 'Enhanced Typesetting' view in Previewer	<i>Most readers use this mode</i>
[]	First 10% of book is compelling — this is the Look Inside sample	<i>Amazon shows the first 10% for free</i>
[]	Copyright page includes year, author name, and rights statement	<i>Required for legal protection</i>
[]	Pricing set correctly for all territories	<i>Check USD, GBP, EUR at minimum</i>
[]	KDP Select enrollment decision made consciously	<i>90-day exclusivity — understand the tradeoff</i>